

2020 AMC 10B Problem 1 - Solution

Review the full statement and step-by-step solution for 2020 AMC 10B Problem 1. Great practice for AMC 10, AMC 12, AIME, and other math contests

2020 AMC 10B Problem 1

Problem:

What is the value of

$$1 - (-2) - 3 - (-4) - 5 - (-6)?$$

Answer Choices:

- A. -20
- B. -3
- C. 3
- D. 5
- E. 21

Solution:

We know that when we subtract negative numbers,

$$a - (-b) = a + b$$

The equation becomes

$$1 + 2 - 3 + 4 - 5 + 6 = \boxed{(D)5}$$

OR

Like Solution 1, we know that when we subtract $a - (-b)$, that will equal $a + b$ as the opposite/negative of a negative is a positive. Thus,

$$1 - (-2) - 3 - (-4) - 5 - (-6) = 1 + 2 - 3 + 4 - 5 + 6$$

We can group together a few terms to make our computation a bit simpler.

$$1 + (2 - 3) + 4 + (-5 + 6) = 1 + (-1) + 4 + 1 = \boxed{(D)5}$$

The problems and solutions on this page are the property of the MAA's [American Mathematics Competitions](#) ↗

Powered by [Wiki.js](#)